

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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HE HIMSELF

THE PERSONAL INVOLVEMENT OF EVENTS THAT GOD & CHRIST ATTEND TO PERSONALLY.

“HE HIMSELF” - NOT SOMEONE ELSE – GOD HIMSELF



Our focus

This week I was so blessed to have my heart stirred again with the “phrase he himself”

“He himself is our peace,” etc.

I awakened to the magnitude of his love and grace shown to us in all those events and acts that he gave his personal attention to.

My prayer is that it may have the same effect on all who read this Ps Barry's Reflection.

Our message

This is about God and Christ and those amazing events and acts that they have personally undertaken themselves.

Those supernatural events that they did not entrust to Angels or Men to carry out but remained the exclusive and personal touch of a master creator and his son – Jesus Christ.

Those acts reflect to all of us the significant importance and value of them which could not be relegated to anyone but themselves personally.

HE HIMSELF - NOT SOMEONE ELSE –

GOD HIMSELF SHALL - give a sign

Isaiah 7:14 Therefore the Lord himself shall give you a sign; Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel. KJV

- God is the one who performed the miracle of Mary becoming pregnant with Child - without a human father.
- This was exclusively the work of God Almighty.

THE LORD HIMSELF SHALL DESCEND

1 Thessalonians 4:16 For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the archangel's voice, and with the trumpet of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first. Holman

- What a comforting thought it is about the second coming of Christ to this earth again.
- Encouraging and reassuring to know is that CHRIST HIMSELF WILL COME DOWN with his angels and all the saints and together we will all be caught up to meet him and be with HIM forever.

JESUS GAVE HIMSELF AS A RANSOM

HE GAVE HIMSELF TO REDEEM US.

1 Timothy 2:6 who gave himself as a ransom for all men — the testimony given in its proper time. NIV

Titus 2:14 who gave himself for us to redeem us from all wickedness and to purify for himself a people that are his very own, eager to do what is good. NIV

He gave himself

Application

- This giving of ourselves is something that we have to learn to do.
- It is not always easy to give of ourselves when it is something that is new to us and we need time to process them in prayer.
- It means the giving of our time, energy and possessions and the changes brings that have to be made to our daily schedule and the re-evaluating of priorities.

- We deliberately choose to give of ourselves because it effectively deals with our tendency to be self-centred, because man without God is basically selfish and it is something that we must challenge on a regular basis.

JESUS EMPTIED / STRIPPED HIMSELF - of all privileges, etc.

*Philippians 2:7 but **emptied himself, by taking the form of a servant**, being born in the likeness of men. ESV*
*Philippians 2:7 Nay, **He stripped Himself of His glory** and **took on Him the nature of a bondservant** by becoming a man like other men. Weymouth*

*Philippians 2:7 But **stripped Himself** [of all privileges and rightful dignity], so as to assume the guise of a servant (slave), in that He became like men and was born a human being. AMP*

He emptied – stripped himself

- He emptied himself of those rights and privileges by choosing to give expression to that of a servant – a Bond servant.

Application

- It's about our willingness to empty or strip ourselves of any form of title, status or honour.
- It is something that we are to do ourselves.
- It's about our refusal to retain our claim to those things.

JESUS HUMBLING HIMSELF

*Philippians 2:8 And being found in appearance as a man, **He humbled Himself** and **became obedient** to the point of death, even the death of the cross. NKJV*

*Philippians 2:8 He humbled Himself by becoming **obedient to the point of death—even to death on a cross**. Holman*

He humbled himself and became obedient!

This is something that he did – this was the result of his choice.

Application

- Humility is something that we choose to do.
- We accept it as our responsibility to act on this in our own lives and obedience is the resulting fruit.
- Yes, it is true that God humbles us, but he also expects that we will humble ourselves and **adopt humility** as a quality that God requires in all of us.
- And it is obedience that helps us make difficult and self-sacrificing decisions and choose the kind of Godly pathways for our lives.

JESUS HIMSELF SUFFERED

*Hebrews 2:18 Because **he himself suffered when he was tempted**, he is able to help those who are being **tempted**. NIV*

*Hebrews 2:18 For since **He Himself was tested and has suffered**, He is able to help those who are **tested**. Holman*

Jesus suffered – was tested- and was able to help the tempted.

Application

- Therefore, we can with confidence come to Jesus for help when we are tempted and tested.
- He declares that he IS willing to help us.
- Jesus, who perfectly understands us when we are tempted and is able to help us in those times when we are tested/tempted.

JESUS HIMSELF WAS SUBJECT TO WEAKNESS

*Hebrews 5:2 And **he is able to deal gently** with ignorant and wayward people because **he himself is subject to the same weaknesses**. NLT*

*Hebrews 5:2 He **is able to deal gently** with those who are ignorant and are going astray, since **he himself is also subject to weakness**. Holman*

Application

- We also are subject to weaknesses.
- He understands that people have weaknesses.
- Note: He deals gently with ignorant and wayward people, people that had wanted or strayed away.

JESUS BY THE ONE SACRIFICE OF HIMSELF - removed sin

*Hebrews 9:26 Otherwise, He would have had to suffer many times since the foundation of the world. But now He has appeared **one time**, at the end of the ages, for the **removal of sin by the sacrifice of Himself**. Holman*

His one sacrifice for the forgiveness of sins forever.

Amazing love and devotion to the Father on our behalf.

Amen – Ps Barry